

The Great Fire of London: answers

Year 5 · 13 marks. Accept any sensible answer that is backed up by the text.

1. Pudding Lane. (1 mark)

Finding information (2b). A fact to find in the second section.

2. Any two of: the houses were made of timber and coated in tar; they were close together; the summer had been dry; a strong east wind carried sparks. (2 marks)

Finding information (2b). Collecting causes from more than one place in the text.

3. Gaps made by pulling down houses, so the flames could not easily cross. (1 mark)

Word meaning (2a). Working out a word from the sentence it sits in.

4. Four days. (1 mark)

Finding information (2b). Using the dates to find a number that is stated in the text.

5. Brick and stone do not burn as easily as timber, so a future fire would be less likely to spread. (2 marks)

Inference (2d). Joining the cause of the fire to the changes made afterwards.

6. Samuel Pepys wrote about it in his diary. (1 mark)

Finding information (2b). Finding out why a source matters.

7. One mark each for: how it started and spread (a baker's shop in Pudding Lane, timber houses, strong wind); the damage (thousands of houses, 87 churches and St Paul's destroyed); the result (new building laws, rebuilding, Pepys's diary). (3 marks)

Summarising (2c). A good summary keeps the main ideas and leaves out the small details. This is the core Year 5 and 6 reading skill.

8. It suggests that more people may have died than were written down in official records. (2 marks)

Inference (2d). One careful word can change the meaning of a sentence. Noticing it is a Year 5 and 6 skill.